IS101 — Excel E5: Manage Charts

College of Southern Nevada

Practice Instructions

Download and open your **Excel_E5_Starter** file. Work through each skill below using the steps provided — each skill lists what to do, exactly how to do it, and what the result should look like. Check off each skill on the IS101 reference page as you complete it.

Skills in This Guide

1 Create a Chart
2 Create a Chart Sheet
3 Add a Data Series to a Chart
4 Switch Between Rows and Columns in Source Data
5 Add and Modify Chart Elements
6 Apply Chart Layouts
7 Apply Chart Styles
8 Add Alternative Text to a Chart

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1. Create a Chart

Your Task: Create a Clustered Column chart showing monthly headcount to visualize staffing trends.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the range A2:B14 (Month and Headcount columns).
2. Click Insert → Insert Column or Bar Chart.
3. Choose Clustered Column from the gallery.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

A new column chart appears on the worksheet, one bar per month, sized to the selected data.

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2. Create a Chart Sheet

Your Task: Move the chart you just created onto its own dedicated chart sheet.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the chart to select it.
2. Click Chart Design → Move Chart.
3. Choose “New sheet,” give it a name, and click OK.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The chart disappears from the worksheet and reappears full-size on its own new tab named for the chart.

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3. Add a Data Series to a Chart

Your Task: Add a second data series (for example, a prior-year comparison) to the existing chart.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the chart to select it.
2. Click Chart Design → Select Data → Add.
3. Set the series name and values to the new column of data, then click OK.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

A second set of bars or a second line appears in the chart alongside the original series, with a matching legend entry.

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4. Switch Between Rows and Columns in Source Data

Your Task: Flip which axis the chart plots by category versus by series, without re-selecting the data.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the chart to select it.
2. Click Chart Design → Switch Row/Column.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The chart's categories and series swap places — what was grouped along the bottom axis now appears as separate series, and vice versa.

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5. Add and Modify Chart Elements

Your Task: Add axis titles, data labels, and gridlines to make the chart easier to read.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the chart, then click the + (Chart Elements) button beside it.
2. Check Axis Titles and type meaningful titles for each axis.
3. Check Data Labels and Gridlines to add both.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

Axis titles appear along each axis, a value label appears above each bar or point, and light gridlines run across the plot area.

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6. Apply Chart Layouts

Your Task: Apply one of Excel's built-in Quick Layouts instead of adding each chart element by hand.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the chart to select it.
2. Click Chart Design → Quick Layout.
3. Choose a layout from the gallery that includes a legend and data labels.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The chart's title, legend, and label placement all update at once to match the chosen layout.

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7. Apply Chart Styles

Your Task: Apply a different built-in color/style combination to the chart.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the chart to select it.
2. Click Chart Design → Chart Styles gallery.
3. Click a different style thumbnail to apply it.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The chart's colors, backgrounds, and series formatting update instantly to match the chosen style.

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8. Add Alternative Text to a Chart

Your Task: Add alt text describing the chart so it's accessible to screen-reader users.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Right-click the chart's border and choose Edit Alt Text.
2. Type a short, clear description of what the chart shows.
3. Close the Alt Text pane.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The chart now carries a text description that a screen reader announces in place of the image.

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